

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 694

By Doggett

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Benjamin and Lauren Neale upon their receipt of the Rural Small Business of the Year award.

WHEREAS, small businesses are the backbone of Tennessee's economy, and the goods and services provided by their diligent proprietors contribute significantly to the overall well-being of the citizens of this State; and

WHEREAS, such estimable small business owners are Benjamin and Lauren Neale, owners of Light Hill Meats, who were awarded the Rural Small Business of the Year award by the United States Small Business Administration's Tennessee District Office; and

WHEREAS, Benjamin Neale was raised on a small farm in Lynnville, where he worked for neighboring farmers and seedstock operations; he earned an undergraduate degree in animal science and master's degrees in agricultural operations and business administration; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Neale, who began building his cow herd in 2011, officially opened the doors to Light Hill Meats in 2017, and has since grown the family enterprise into an integrated farm-to-table beef business with a deep commitment to the community; and

WHEREAS, today, Light Hill Meats includes a cow-calf herd, a USDA-inspected processing facility for cattle, pigs, sheep, and goats, and a retail butcher shop that serves families throughout Middle Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Light Hill Meats Butcher Shop features local beef and pork, as well as seafood and chicken, and specializes in a fourteen-day dry hang process to enhance the meat's tenderness and flavor; and

WHEREAS, during the COVID-19 pandemic, Lauren Neale identified a need for supplying meat to concerned parents in the community; the Neales launched a pop-up shop at first and in 2022, began construction for a retail location in Spring Hill; and

WHEREAS, Light Hill Meats Custom Processing operates out of Lynnville, and the facility services both the USDA and custom processing of cattle, sheep, and pigs; and

WHEREAS, leaders in their profession and the community, Benjamin and Lauren Neale care deeply about leaving a positive impact on the lives of citizens and their employees and often host creative events for special needs children and support organizations for autism and sober living; and

WHEREAS, their professional accomplishments aside, Benjamin and Lauren Neale are the proud parents of four children: Corban, Abigail, Elizabeth, and Sarah; and

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that we join in acknowledging these exceptional Tennessee entrepreneurs; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we congratulate Benjamin and Lauren Neale upon their receipt of the Rural Small Business of the Year award from the U.S. Small Business Administration's Tennessee District Office, extending our best wishes for much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.